

Ethan Zaruba-Walker

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Dear James Jiao,

I am writing about the founding Forward Deployed Engineer role in San Francisco, five days a week. A pilot is the deal only if the customer sees their own workflow running. For three years I have been the person who scopes that proof, builds the integration, and stays through launch. I live in Emeryville.

Conversion is the agentic marketing automation platform you and Neil Tewari built so teams can leave Marketo, HubSpot, and Pardot, and the \$28M Series A on conversion.ai is the public account of that bet. I have not administered those three products. I have connected the systems a team already uses, with Python, REST, webhooks, and n8n, and I have put a measured result on the other side of the change.

What I would do in the seat:

- **Proof before the pitch hardens:** discovery, a written scope, and a working slice on the customer's data. My own engagements are milestone-gated and have reached \$18K.
- **Integrations and pipelines:** one ingestion rebuild raised throughput 99.8% in four months and cut cost 86%. Claude Code is how I iterate that build with the customer watching.
- **Back into the product:** repeated customer needs become the next reusable workflow, not a private script. I write the spec so engineering is not reconstructing the call.

Thank you for writing the role in your own voice. I would welcome a conversation about which pilot you want a founding forward deployed engineer to land first.

Sincerely,

Ethan Zaruba-Walker